

Gestalt Principles Website Review

Apple

Figure-ground

The product message stands out clearly against the muted background.



College, sorted.

Get a gift card from \$100 to \$150*
when you buy Mac or iPad with
education savings.

Shop



Proximity

The headline and button are grouped together as one clear action.

iPhone

Meet the latest iPhone lineup.

Learn more

Shop iPhone





MacBook Air

Now supercharged by M5.

[Learn more](#)

[Buy](#)

Now supercharged by M4.

[Learn more](#)

[Buy](#)

MacBook Pro

Now with M5, M5 Pro, and M5 Max.

[Learn more](#)

[Buy](#)

The ultimate way to
watch your health.

[Learn more](#)

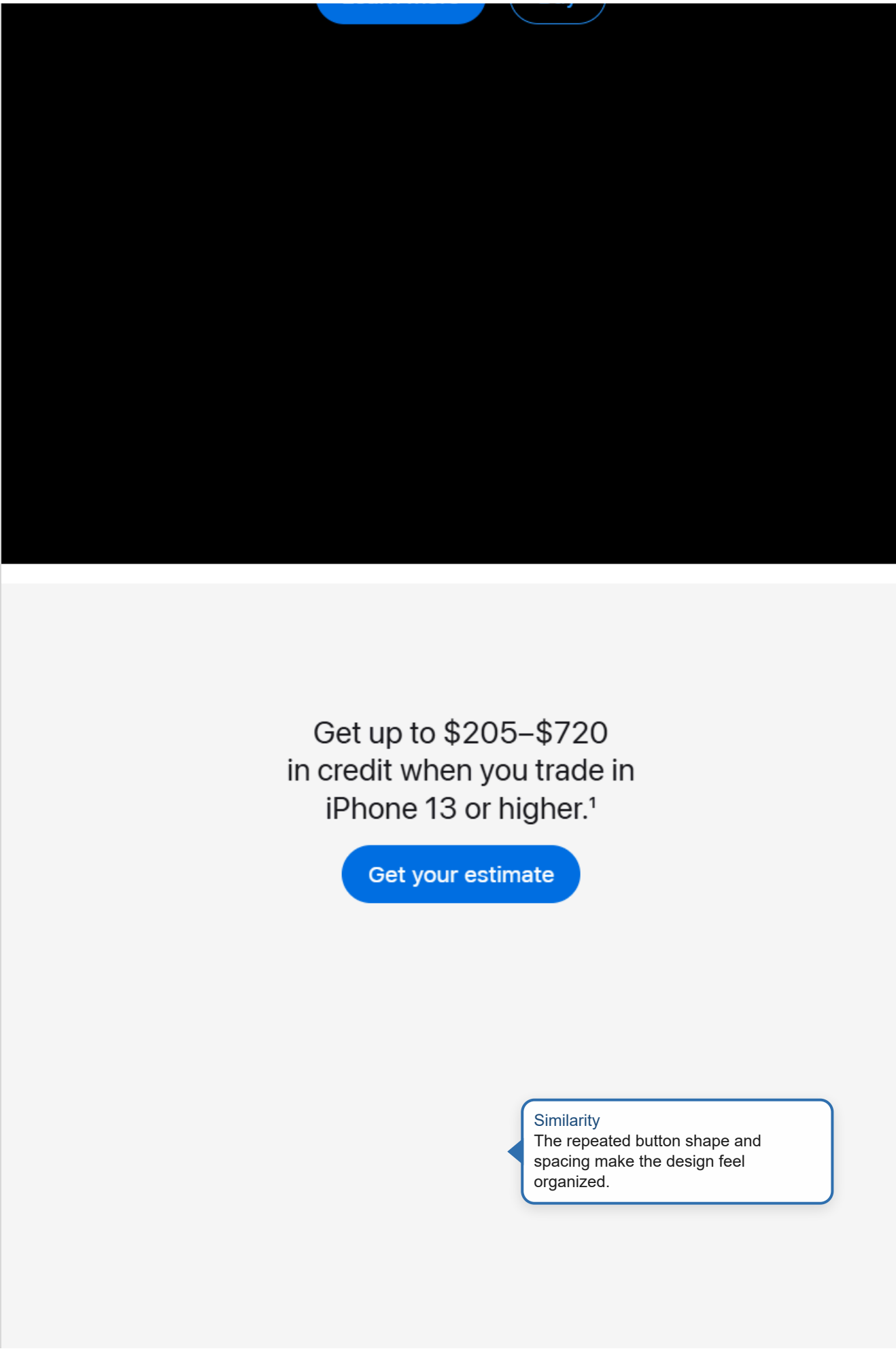
[Buy](#)

iPad Pro

Advanced AI performance
and game-changing capabilities.

[Learn more](#)

[Buy](#)



Get up to \$205–\$720
in credit when you trade in
iPhone 13 or higher.¹

Get your estimate

Similarity

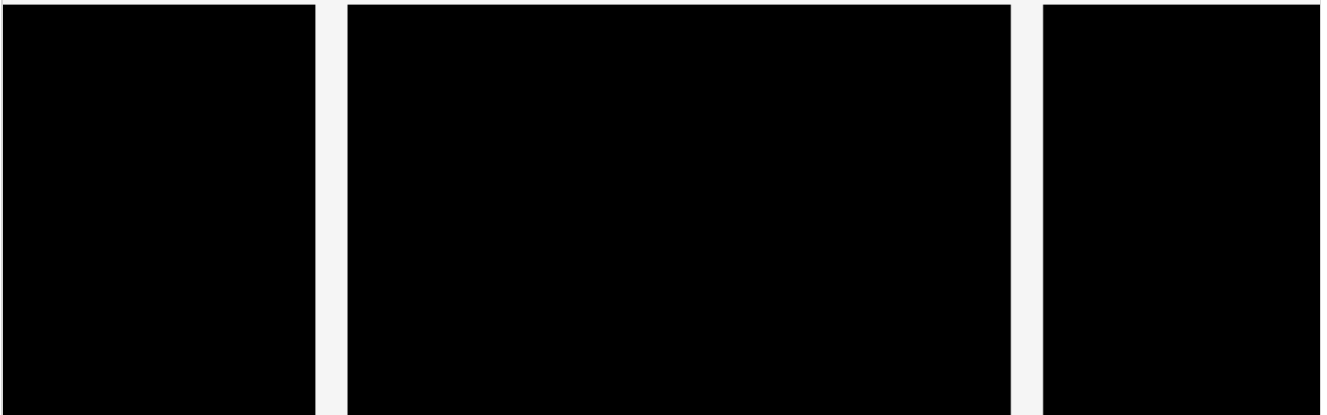
The repeated button shape and spacing make the design feel organized.

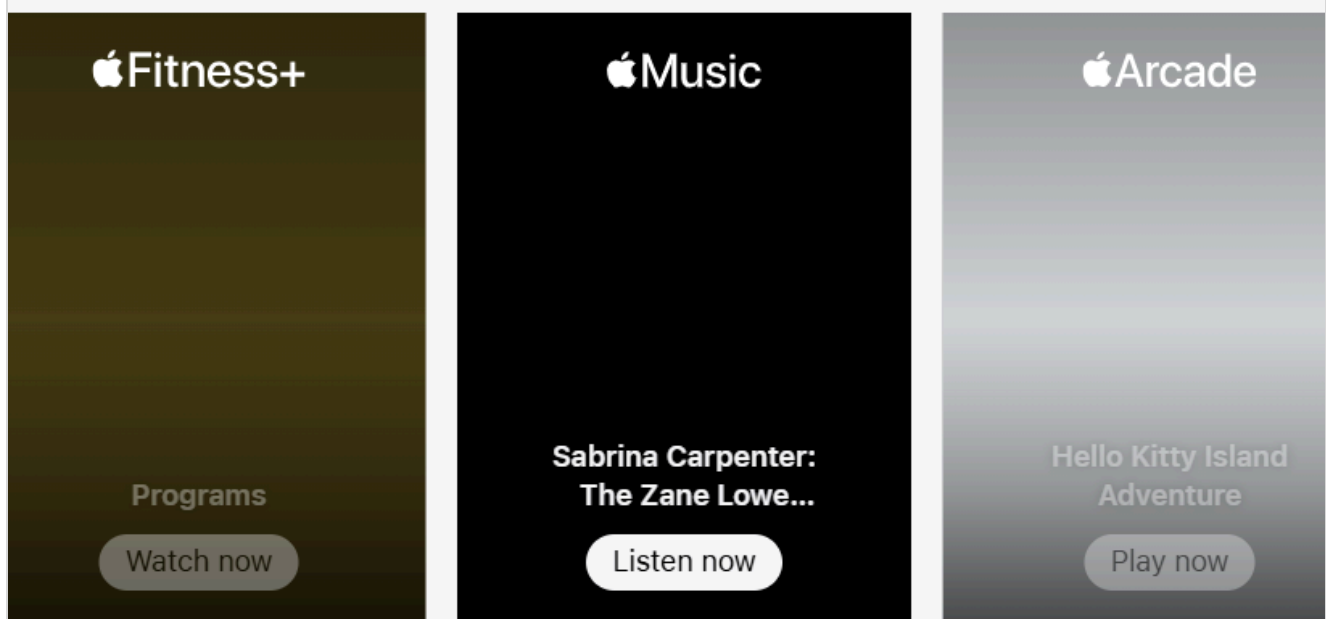
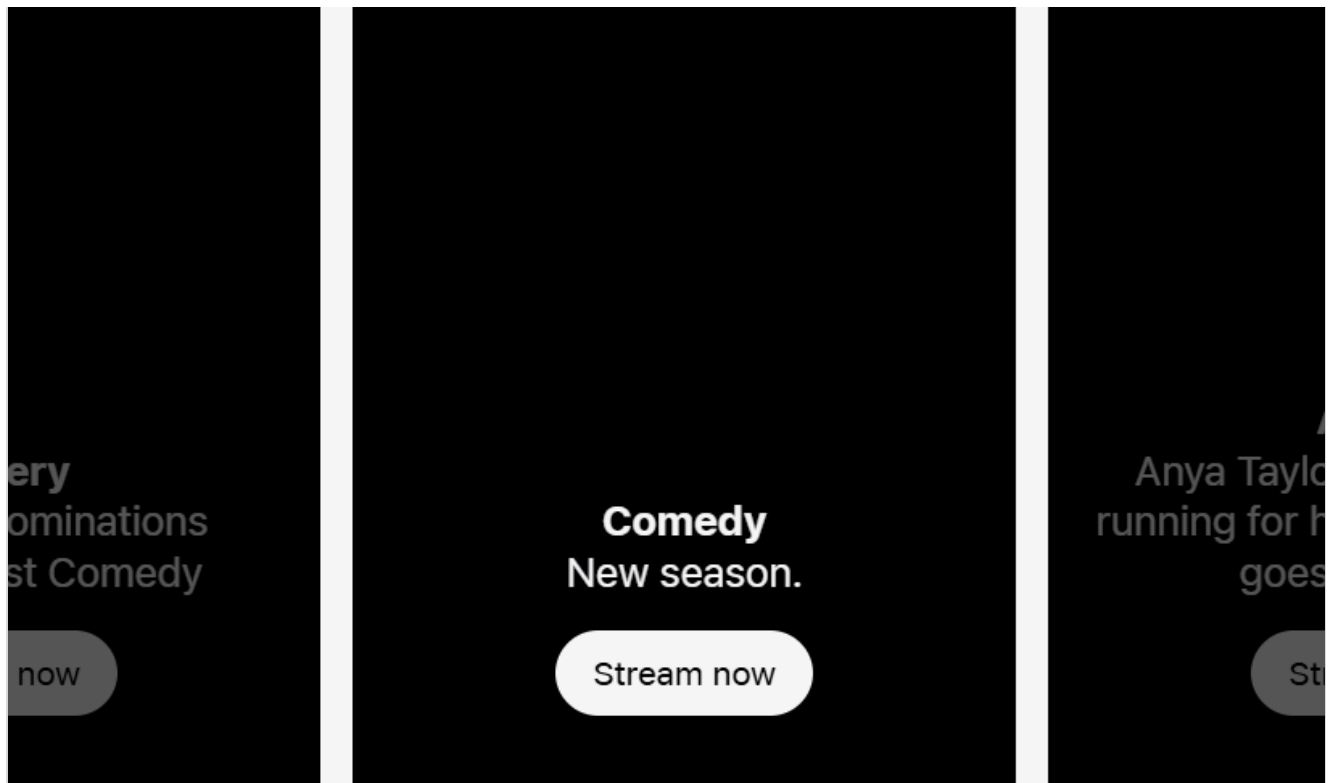
Get up to 3% Daily Cash back
with every purchase.

Learn more

Apply now

Endless entertainment.





* Available for Qualified Purchasers only. Qualified Purchasers receive an Apple Gift Card when they purchase an eligible Mac or iPad ("Eligible Product") at a Qualifying Location through September 24, 2026. Gift card values may vary by Eligible Product. Customers will receive a discount equal to the value of the Apple Gift Card off the price of the Eligible Product, but will be charged for all items in their cart, including the Apple Gift Card. Only one Apple Gift Card per Eligible Product per Qualified Purchaser. Offer subject to availability. While supplies last. Additional restrictions apply. View full offer terms [here](#).

1. Trade-in values will vary based on the condition, year, and configuration of your eligible trade-in device. Not all devices are eligible for credit. You must be at least the age of majority to be eligible to trade in for credit or for an Apple Gift Card. Trade-in value may

be applied toward qualifying new device purchase, or added to an Apple Gift Card. Actual value awarded is based on receipt of a qualifying device matching the description provided when estimate was made. Sales tax may be assessed on full value of a new device purchase. In-store trade-in requires presentation of a valid photo ID (local law may require saving this information). Offer may not be available in all stores and may vary between in-store and online trade-in. Some stores may have additional requirements. Apple or its trade-in partners reserve the right to refuse, cancel, or limit quantity of any trade-in transaction for any reason. More details are available from Apple's trade-in partner for trade-in and recycling of eligible devices. Restrictions and limitations may apply.

To access and use all Apple Card features and products available only to Apple Card users, you must add Apple Card to Wallet on an iPhone or iPad that supports and has the latest version of iOS or iPadOS. Apple Card is subject to credit approval, available only for qualifying applicants in the United States, and issued by Goldman Sachs Bank USA, Salt Lake City Branch.

Apple Payments Services LLC, a subsidiary of Apple Inc., is a service provider of Goldman Sachs Bank USA for Apple Card and Savings accounts. Neither Apple Inc. nor Apple Payments Services LLC is a bank.

All communications from Apple and Goldman Sachs Bank USA about Apple Card (including transactional and marketing communications) and customer service support are available in English. Certain communications about Apple Card can be viewed in another language depending on your device language settings. If you reside in the U.S. Virgin Islands, American Samoa, Guam, Northern Mariana Islands, or U.S. Minor Outlying Islands, please call Goldman Sachs at 877-255-5923 with questions about Apple Card.

Learn more about how Apple Card applications are evaluated at support.apple.com/kb/HT209218.

A subscription is required for Apple Arcade, Apple Fitness+, Apple Music, and Apple TV.

Features are subject to change. Some features, applications, and services may not be available in all regions or all languages.

Shop and Learn



Apple Wallet



Account



Entertainment



Apple Store

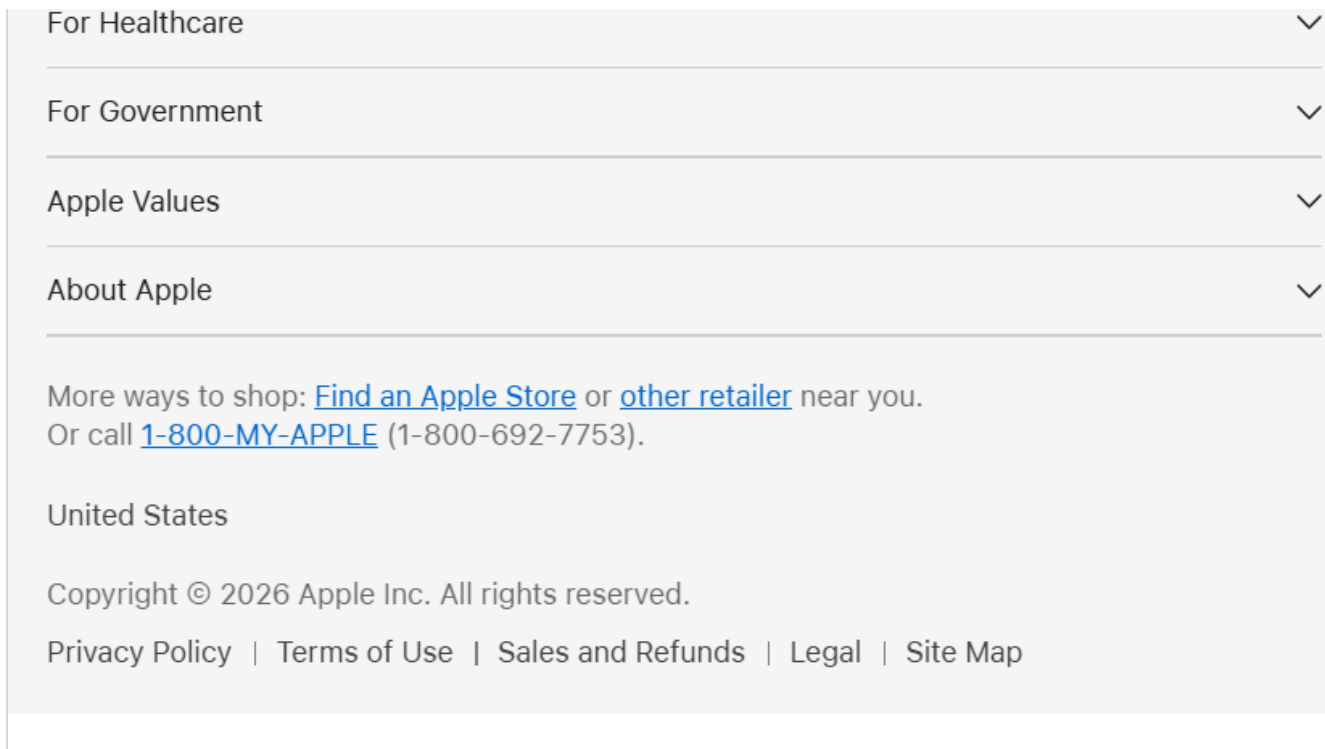


For Business



For Education



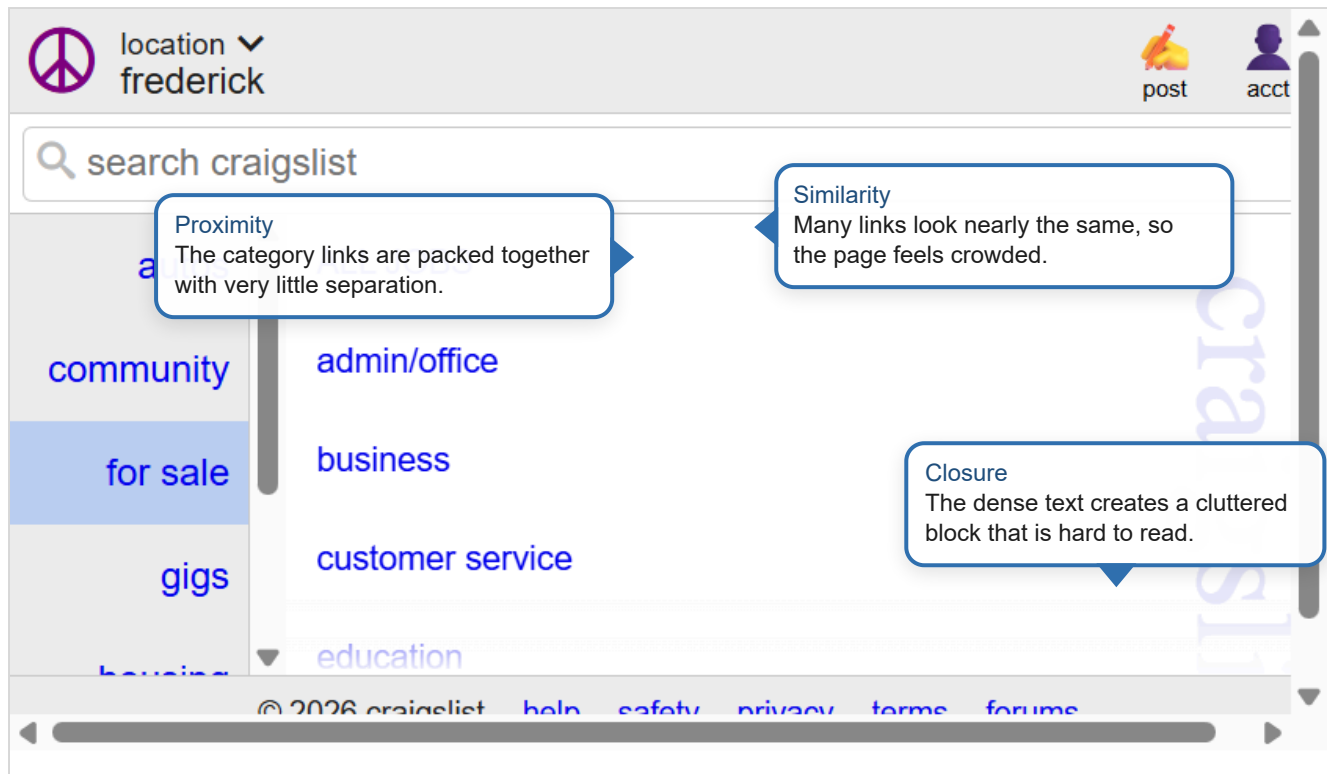


Apple is a strong example of good Gestalt design because it helps the eye understand the page quickly. The first principle at work is proximity. The headline, supporting text, and main button sit close together, so they feel like one clear message rather than separate pieces. This reduces mental effort because the user does not have to sort through unrelated content to understand the page. The page feels calm and intentional, which makes the experience smoother.

The second principle is similarity. The repeated button shapes, spacing, and product-card style create a visual pattern that feels organized. Because similar elements look alike, the user can tell what is important and what is interactive without much effort. This makes navigation easy and reduces confusion. The layout also uses figure-ground well, because the hero product stands apart from the quieter background. That gives the user a clear focal point and helps the message land immediately.

Overall, Apple does a good job guiding attention. The page feels clean, premium, and simple. It helps people understand the offer quickly and take the next step without having to work too hard.

Craigslist



Craigslist is a useful example of how weak Gestalt design can hurt usability. One problem is proximity. The category links are packed closely together with very little spacing, so the eye struggles to tell what belongs together. Instead of feeling like organized groups, the page looks like one large block of text. That slows users down and makes scanning harder than it should be.

The second issue is similarity. Many links share the same size, weight, and spacing, so they look almost identical. When elements are too similar, it is harder to tell one section from another. This creates more reading and less fast recognition. The layout also weakens closure, because the dense arrangement does not give the page clear chunks of information. The result is a cluttered, unfinished feeling that makes the experience harder to navigate.

In practical terms, Craigslist still works functionally, but it does not guide the eye well. People have to decode the layout before they can act. That makes the experience slower and less confident. Apple uses Gestalt principles to create clarity, while Craigslist shows how poor grouping and spacing can make even basic browsing feel harder than it needs to be.

Review based on two real websites and their use of visual grouping.